



Write to the Editor

E-mail: editor@thinkdigit.com

Snail Mail: The Editor, Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar Building, MIDC, TTC Industrial Estate, Nerul, Navi Mumbai 400 706

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For subscription queries, call the Help Desk at 022-27629191/9200 Fax 022-27629224, or send an e-mail to help@jasubhai.com

Inbox

particularly liked the *Tech Review 2004*, which had all the elements you ever wanted in a year-end issue. But where did the DVD jewel case go? Until November 2004, the *Digit* DVD came in a jewel case. This stopped in the December issue. Why? Also, why don't you give *avast!* free anti-virus software, and maybe the *Google Desktop Search*?

Sudhir Banerjee
via E-mail

Dear Anshul and Sudhir

Thank you very much for your kind words. We had mixed feelings bringing out the December 2004 issue—on the one hand we were happy we brought out such a great issue, on the other the perpetual feeling whether our readers would love it. But the response was phenomenal, and our issue was a sellout even before December 20, 2004.

Meanwhile, the December issue had more than 200 pages, and this issue has more than 160. As India's leading technology publication, we have always believed in giving our readers more bang for their buck. This is more than evident in the number of pages, and the amount of software and games we bung into the DVD. So you are right, Anshul. Digit will never let you down. Sudhir, as far as your requests are concerned about *avast!* and *Google Desktop Search*, all you need to do is reach out to this month's DVD right now!

— Executive Editor

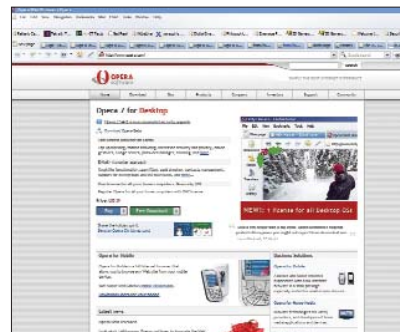
Firefox Good, Opera Better

The Mozilla Firefox 1.0 review in the December 2004 issue was a nice read. However being an *Opera* user for more than a year, I can say quite confidently that *Firefox* 1.0 is overhyped. Is it really a revolution? I don't think so. *Opera* had tabbed browsing, dynamic cache usage and voice browsing much before everyone else. So why didn't anyone call *Opera* as a browsing revolution?

Here are a few things that make *Opera* really really good:

- 1) It loads pages faster than most browsers because of its superb cache handling feature.
- 2) It allows you to resume sessions from where you left last time (my favourite feature)
- 3) Excellent e-mail client M2
- 4) Allows you to zoom in and out of the pages. The zoom out feature may come handy to tackle annoying horizontal scrolling in some pages

- 5) It has a basic form filler
- 6) It has Magic Wand, the user-friendly password manager (another handy tool)
- 7) The search engine tab which is better than Firefox any day. In fact, in *Opera* you can even add your own search engine by using a small freeware tool
- 8) It even has an IRC client, a chat feature and the ability to receive RSS feeds
- 9) It has fairly advanced voice browsing, along with a pleasing interface and lots of skins
- 10) Mouse gestures are default in *Opera*, whereas in Firefox you need extensions
- 11) It has a small download size, has pop-up blockers, a download manager, etc.



Actually, the media is hyping *Firefox* just because it was developed by the Open Source community. While I admit that Microsoft's domination of the browser industry is being eroded fast because of *Firefox*, *Opera* has also played an important role in making that dent. It is good that people are moving away from Internet Explorer, which many advanced users feel is the worst of all the current browsers.

Meanwhile, thank you for an excellent year-end issue. And yes, it was great to see Agent 001 back after a long break.

Pallab De
via E-mail

Clarification

In the November and December 2004 issues, we ran a contest for 'Check Your TQ', where one lucky winner won a Canon Pixma printer for each month. Many readers wrote to us saying they too answered all 10 answers correctly, but did not receive any printer. This is to clarify that all our contests will have only winner, and if there are multiple all-correct entries, then the winner will be decided by draw of lots.

— Executive Editor

Price, Piracy, Problems

I use *Windows XP* at home, and like millions of XP users I had to face nightmares while going online for days on end.

Whenever I went online the PC was infected with worms like *My Web Search*, popups, etc. The very process of using my dial-up connection to connect to the Net made me paranoid. I removed the bugs using *Spybot* when they entered the system again the next day.

When I was in school I had heard that "Eternal vigil was the price of independence". It was only now that I could appreciate its true meaning. In my version, though, I could replace the word independence with "infectionless". Over a period, I gave up surfing! And then it was not possible for me to download the 250 MB security update for XP.

Then I came across link on Microsoft's Web site that read: "Protect your PC in three steps". It was the Holy Grail I was looking for so badly. The site said Microsoft will send a free CD-ROM of Win XP SP2. They even sent me an e-mail confirmation of my order.

After a week or two, the wait ended. I thanked and prayed for dear Bill Gates as I inserted the CD. And promptly came the message: "Your version of *Windows XP* is not registered. Please register blah, blah, blah..." My heart stopped. Indeed my version was not registered, and was installed from a pirated CD. It is a different story that after this, I bought a legal version of XP, and now I can surf the Net without any problems.

It is not my intention to bring to everybody's notice that I had been using a pirated version of XP, but the fact that Microsoft should understand that because of its short-sighted pricing policy, the legal sales of its software will never hit a high in most places across the world. For instance, how many legal copies of XP are there in Indian homes today? It is a question that cannot be buried under the carpet.

Sourav
via E-mail

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH